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Subtraction

Subtraction is used to find the difference between numbers. To subtract, put the larger number on top. If a digit in the top number is smaller than the digit below it, you need to **regroup** (borrow) from a higher place value column.

Example

Hide

Game Time, a video game store, has 3,025 games in stock. The store sold 287 games on Monday. How many games are still in stock?

Estimate first.

Round both numbers and subtract.

$$\begin{array}{r} 3000 \\ -\ 300 \\ \hline 2700 \end{array}$$

Step 1

Subtract the ones. Since you cannot subtract 7 from 5, regroup 1 ten.

$$\begin{array}{r} 3025 \\ -287 \\ \hline \end{array} \qquad \begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 1} \\ 30\cancel{2}^{1}5 \\ -28\ 7 \\ \hline 8 \end{array}$$

Step 2

Subtract the tens. You can't subtract 8 from 1. You can regroup across the 0. Borrow 1 from 30. Then continue to subtract.

$$\begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 2\ 9\ 11} \\ \cancel{3}\,\cancel{0}\,\cancel{2}^{1}5 \\ -\ 2\ 8\ 7 \\ \hline 3\ 8 \end{array} \qquad \begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 2\ 9\ 11} \\ \cancel{3}\,\cancel{0}\,\cancel{2}^{1}5 \\ -\ 2\ 8\ 7 \\ \hline 2\ 7\ 3\ 8 \end{array}$$

Check: The answer **2,738** is close to 2,700.

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Lesson 2: Operations with Whole Numbers and Decimals

Related Questions:

Practice questions taken related to this topic

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